

Short Questions

1. Define Moral Intuitions (pg. 144)

Moral intuitions are the feelings or instincts we have about what is right or wrong, without needing detailed reasoning or arguments.

2. Define Moral Principles (pg. 150)

Moral principles are general rules or guidelines that help us decide what is right and wrong in different situations.

3. Define Ethical Subjectivism & Ethical Objectivism

- **Ethical Subjectivism:** The belief that moral truths depend on individual opinions or feelings.
- **Ethical Objectivism:** The belief that moral truths exist independently of individual opinions or feelings.

4. Define Relativism and Cultural Relativism

- **Relativism:** The idea that moral truths depend on the context, culture, or situation.
- **Cultural Relativism:** The belief that moral values and practices are determined by a culture and cannot be judged by outsiders.

5. Define "Virtue" in Virtue Ethics. Give an Example of Virtue Ethics.

- **Virtue:** A good quality or trait of character, like honesty or courage, that helps a person live a good life.
- **Example:** A virtuous person helps others because they are compassionate, not because they expect a reward.

6. Define Utilitarianism

Utilitarianism is the ethical theory that actions are good if they maximize happiness or well-being for the greatest number of people.

7. Difference Between Deontological Ethics and Consequentialist Ethics

- **Deontological Ethics:** Focuses on following rules or duties regardless of the outcome.
- **Consequentialist Ethics:** Focuses on the results or consequences of actions to determine if they are right or wrong.

8. Define Good and Bad Action According to Virtue Ethics

- **Good Action:** An action that reflects virtues like kindness, honesty, or courage.
- **Bad Action:** An action that reflects vices like selfishness, dishonesty, or cruelty.

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9. Define Principles of Utilitarianism

The main principle of utilitarianism is to act in a way that brings the greatest happiness or reduces the most suffering for the greatest number of people.

10. Define Kantian "Principle of Universalizability"

The principle of universalizability states that an action is morally right if it can be applied as a universal rule that everyone can follow without contradiction.

Long Questions

1. What is Deontological Ethics? Give a Detailed Explanation of "Kantian Ethics".

- **Deontological Ethics:** This ethical theory focuses on following rules, duties, or obligations, regardless of the outcome. It says actions are morally right if they adhere to specific rules or principles.
- **Kantian Ethics:**
 - **Immanuel Kant** is the main thinker behind this theory.
 - It emphasizes the importance of rationality and morality based on duty, not emotions or consequences.

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- **Key Principles:**

- ▶ **Categorical Imperative:** Always act in a way that your action can become a universal rule (everyone should follow it).

- ▶ **Respect for Humanity:** Treat others as ends in themselves, not as means to an end. This means valuing every person's dignity and worth.

- **Example:** If lying is wrong, you should never lie, even if it leads to good results.

2. Critically Evaluate the Ethical Theory of Utilitarianism

- **Definition:** Utilitarianism says an action is morally right if it brings the most happiness or reduces the most suffering for the greatest number of people.
- **Strengths:**
 - Simple to apply: Focus on maximizing happiness.
 - Flexible: Can adapt to different situations.
 - Promotes overall well-being: Encourages actions that help the majority.

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- **Weaknesses:**
 - Ignores individual rights: May sacrifice the happiness of a few for the majority.
 - Hard to predict consequences: It's not always possible to know if an action will lead to happiness.
 - Focuses only on results: Does not consider the morality of actions themselves.
- **Example:** If lying saves many lives, utilitarianism would say lying is right.

3. "Golden Mean Virtue" is the Only Reliable Ethical Principle. Explain in the Light of Aristotelian Virtue Ethics.

- **Golden Mean Virtue:** A concept from Aristotle that says virtue is the balance (or "mean") between two extremes—excess and deficiency.
 - **Example:** Courage is the balance between recklessness (too much) and cowardice (too little).
- **Virtue Ethics:** Focuses on developing good character traits (virtues) rather than following rules.

- **Why Reliable?**

- Encourages personal growth: Helps people become better individuals.
- Applies to real life: Avoids extremes and finds a balanced approach.
- Promotes long-term happiness: Virtuous actions lead to a fulfilling life.

- **Criticism:**

- Difficult to find the "mean" in every situation.
- Depends on individual judgment, which can vary.

4. Define Relativism. Explain in Detail the Various Forms of Ethical Relativism.

- **Relativism:** The idea that moral truths depend on the situation, culture, or individual perspective, rather than being absolute.
- **Forms of Ethical Relativism:**
 - **Cultural Relativism:** Morality depends on cultural practices.
 - ▶ Example: Some cultures accept arranged marriages, while others don't.
 - **Moral Subjectivism:** Morality is based on personal feelings or opinions.
 - ▶ Example: One person may think lying is wrong, while another doesn't.

- **Situational Ethics:** Morality changes depending on the situation.

- ▶ Example: Stealing might be acceptable if it's to save someone's life.

- **Criticism of Relativism:**

- No universal moral standards:
Makes it hard to judge right and wrong.
 - Can lead to moral confusion or acceptance of harmful practices.

5. Critically Evaluate the Best Ethical Theory of Your Own Interest

- Choose an ethical theory (e.g., **Kantian Ethics, Utilitarianism, Virtue Ethics**).
- **Example: Kantian Ethics**
 - **Strengths:**
 - ▶ Provides clear rules: You know exactly what is right and wrong.
 - ▶ Respects individual dignity: Focuses on treating everyone with respect.

- **Weaknesses:**

- ▶ Too rigid: Does not allow exceptions.
- ▶ Ignores consequences:
Sometimes, the results matter more than the rule.

- **Why Best?:**

- ▶ Kantian ethics ensures fairness and justice in all situations.